



NF PRO CLIPPER

TRANSPARENT PEAK CLIPPER

Version 1.0.0 · Neno Fernando Audio Tools · VST3 / AU

1. Overview

NF Pro Clipper is a transparent peak clipper for mastering, mix bus and individual-track loudness work. Instead of a hard brick-wall limiter, it removes overshoots with a **soft-knee clipping curve** that you can shape directly, so the transition from clean signal to clipped signal is gradual and musical rather than abrupt.

Its signal path is: **Input trim** → **Drive** → **Clip stage (Ceiling + Knee + Clip Mode, with optional oversampling)** → **Tone** → **Mix** → **Output trim**. Because the clip stage sits mid-chain, you can push the signal into it hard with Drive and then bring the overall level back down with Output, all while watching exactly how much is being shaved off in real time on the transfer graph and the Reduction meter.

2. The Top Bar

The top of the plug-in carries the branding, the preset navigator and the skin switch.

- **NF logo** — if you have resized the plug-in window larger than its default size (by dragging the small resize handle in the bottom-right corner), clicking the "NF" logo instantly snaps the window back to its default size.
- **PRO CLIPPER title** — click this title at any time to open this manual, in English or Portuguese, as a PDF.
- **< / preset name / >** — step backward/forward through the saved preset list. The current preset name is shown in the black display between the arrows.
- **SKIN** — toggles between the two colour skins (purple and black/yellow). Only the colour palette changes; every control stays in the same place.



Top bar: logo, title, preset navigator and skin switch.

3. Meters, Graph and Main Gain Stages

The centre of the plug-in shows you what is happening to the signal, and the three main gain knobs that shape it.

- **IN / OUT meters** — stereo peak meters for the signal arriving at the plug-in and the signal leaving it.
- **Transfer graph** — plots output level against input level for the current Ceiling/Knee/Clip Mode settings, so you can see the exact shape of the clipping curve you have dialled in before it ever touches audio.
- **INPUT** — trims the signal before it reaches Drive and the clip stage. Use this to compensate for a track that is already hot or quiet.
- **DRIVE** — pushes the signal harder into the clipper. More Drive means more of the waveform crosses the Ceiling and gets clipped.
- **OUTPUT** — trims the final level after the Mix stage, to match the loudness you had going in (gain-staging) or to hit a specific target level.



IN/OUT meters, transfer graph, and the Input / Drive / Output knobs.

4. Shaping the Clip

These four knobs and three menus define exactly how the clipping curve behaves.

Control	Range	Default	What it does
Ceiling	-12.0 to 0.0 dB	-0.3 dB	The level above which the signal is clipped. Lower it to clip more of the signal.
Knee	0.0 to 12.0 dB	6.0 dB	How gradually the curve bends into the ceiling. 0 dB is a hard, immediate clip; higher values soften the transition over a wider range for a more transparent, analogue-like result.
Mix	0 to 100 %	100 %	Blends the clipped signal with the dry (unclipped) signal in parallel — a form of parallel saturation. Lower values keep more of the original transient detail.
Tone	-100 to 100 %	0 %	Tilts the tonal balance of the clipped signal: negative values warm it up, positive values brighten it.

Clip Mode (Soft / Medium / Hard, default Soft) selects the character of the clipping curve itself — Soft is the most transparent and rounded, Hard approaches a brick-wall clip with the least headroom recovery.

Oversampling (1x / 2x / 4x / 8x / 16x, default 4x) runs the clip stage at a higher internal sample rate to reduce aliasing produced by the hard non-linearity of clipping. Higher settings sound cleaner on high-frequency material at the cost of CPU.

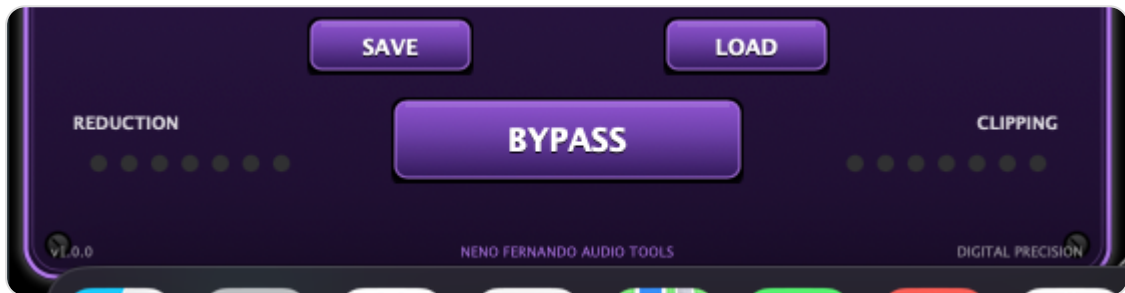
Monitor (IN / OUT / CLIP, default OUT) lets you listen to the input signal, the output signal, or, in CLIP mode, only the difference removed by the clipper — the fastest way to hear exactly what is being shaved off.



Ceiling, Knee, Mix, Tone and the Clip Mode / Oversampling / Monitor menus.

5. Presets, Metering and Bypass

- **SAVE** — stores the current settings as a new preset.
- **LOAD** — opens a file picker to load a preset from disk.
- **REDUCTION** dots — light up to show how much gain is currently being removed by the clipper.
- **CLIPPING** dots — light up when the signal is actively hitting the Ceiling.
- **BYPASS** — disables clipping entirely so you can A/B against the dry signal.



Preset save/load, the Reduction and Clipping meters, and Bypass.

6. Tips

Start with Ceiling near 0 dB and Drive low. Raise Drive gradually while watching the Reduction meter and the transfer graph — you want to see clipping happen, not just guess at it.

If the top end feels harsh after heavy clipping, raise Oversampling before reaching for Tone — a lot of perceived harshness is aliasing, not the clip curve itself.

Use Monitor → CLIP to solo exactly what the clipper is removing. If it sounds like useful transient detail, back off Drive or open up the Knee.

The plug-in window can be resized freely from the bottom-right corner for a larger view on high-resolution screens — click the "NF" logo any time to snap it back to its default size.